

**Dr. D. Y. Patil Technical Campus Varale , Talegaon, Pune
(Savitribai Phule Pune University)**

[Institute Code: 6991]



**A
Case Study
On
“Case Study On how Zerodha scaled in India using a
digital-first approach”**

**SUBMITTED BY:
Landage Rohan Ramesh**

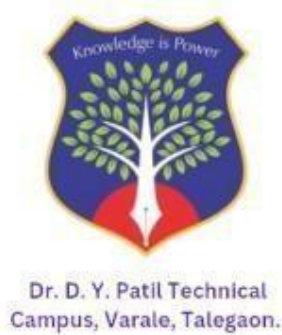
**Under the Guidance of
Asst Prof . Kirti Kamble**

**DEPARTMENT OF ELECTRONIC & COMPUTER
ENGINEERING
(Academic Year: 2025-26)**

Dr. D. Y. Patil Technical Campus

(Savitribai Phule Pune University)

Department of Electronic & Computer Engineering



CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that

Landage Rohan Ramesh

Have completed the necessary case study and prepared the bonafide on

“Case Study On how Zerodha scaled in India using a digital-first approach”

In a satisfactory manner as a partial fulfillment of the requirement of Second-Year BE in Electronic & Computer Engineering for the academic year 2025-26

Asst Prof . Kirti Kamble

Prof . Prashant Kathole

Case Study On how Zerodha scaled in India using a digital-first approach



1. Company Overview

Zerodha was founded in 2010 by Nithin Kamath and Nikhil Kamath. It is India's largest stockbroker by active clients and is known for disrupting the traditional brokerage industry through technology and low-cost pricing.

2. Problem Identification (Urban & Retail Investor Pain Points)

Before Zerodha, the Indian stock market faced major issues:

- High brokerage fees charged by traditional brokers
 - Complex and outdated trading platforms
 - Lack of transparency in pricing
 - Limited access for small retail investors
 - Dependency on physical branches and agents
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3. Digital-First Strategy

A. Fully Online Platform

- Paperless account opening (e-KYC)
 - No need for physical offices
 - Entire trading process handled via web/mobile
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B. Disruptive Pricing Model

- Flat ₹20 brokerage per trade
 - Zero brokerage for equity delivery
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C. Technology-Driven Products

- Kite → fast, user-friendly trading interface
 - Coin → direct mutual fund investments
 - Console → portfolio tracking & analytics
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D. Education & Content Strategy

- Zerodha Varsity → free stock market learning
 - Blogs, tutorials, and community engagement
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E. Bootstrapped Growth Model

- No heavy venture capital funding
 - Focus on profitability from early stages
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4. Scaling Factors

Factor	Impact
Digital onboarding	Rapid customer acquisition
Low-cost structure	High user adoption
Scalable technology	Handles millions of trades
Product ecosystem	Strong user retention
Mobile-first India	Increased accessibility

5. Why Zerodha Succeeded

1. Right Timing

- Growth of smartphones and internet penetration in India

2. Regulatory Support

- Simplified KYC norms enabled digital onboarding

3. Customer Trust

- Transparent pricing, no hidden charges

4. Cost Leadership

- Lower operational expenses due to no physical branches
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6. Challenges Faced

- Handling high traffic loads during market volatility
 - Competition from new fintech players
 - Maintaining platform reliability at scale
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7. Key Outcomes

- Became India's **largest stockbroker**
 - Millions of active users
 - Highly profitable without external funding
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8. Key Learnings

- Digital-first models can scale rapidly with **low cost**
- Solving real pain points (cost + complexity) drives adoption
- Education builds long-term customer trust
- Sustainable growth > aggressive funding

